

On-call handover: Payments

Week of 14 September 2026 · handed over Monday 09:30 · print it or keep it open

Read this before you take the pager. It is one week of context, not a runbook — the runbook is a separate document and it is the thing to open when something is actually paging.

What you are taking on

- **checkout-service** — the one that pages. Two incidents this month, both releases, both rolled back.
- **ledger-writer** — quiet, but it is the only service with no automatic rollback. If it needs one, it is a manual deploy and it takes eleven minutes.
- **refund-worker** — a queue. It has never paged. When it backs up it does so slowly, so the alert is a warning rather than a page, and it usually clears itself.

Live right now

The connection-pool fix is half done. The queue is bounded, which is the half that stops an outage. Taking the pool out of the health check is still in review, so a struggling database will still remove every instance at once. If that happens, roll back or scale out; do not wait for the database to recover on its own.

- A release freeze is in force until Thursday while the payment processor migrates. Emergency rollbacks are still allowed — the freeze is on new features, not on undoing them.
- The staging database was restored from a Friday snapshot, so anything you test against it is a week stale.
- One customer, a large one, is being manually reconciled after the 8 September incident. Their account is flagged; do not run bulk refunds this week without asking.

Things that look wrong and are not

- **A spike at 02:00 every night.** That is the reconciliation job. It lasts about four minutes and it is supposed to.
- **Error rate rising every Friday afternoon.** A partner retries aggressively into an endpoint they should not be using. It is their bug, it is filed, and it does no harm.
- **The dashboard's p99 flatlining.** It flatlines when there is no traffic, not when everything is fast.

If you need somebody

- Say it in the team channel first, even if it is only **I have it**. Two people on one incident separately is worse than one person on it slowly.
- The Payments lead is reachable out of hours and would much rather be woken than told afterwards.
- The database team has its own rota and answers quickly. You do not need permission to page them.

Before you hand it on

1. Update this card. It is only worth reading because the last person did.
2. Close or re-assign anything you opened. An alert that was silenced for a day and never un-silenced is how the next outage goes unnoticed.
3. Say out loud what you did not get to. Nobody finishes a week of on-call with an empty list, and pretending otherwise is what makes the next person think they are the only one.

Sample content for Multirepo Reader. The services, the week and the people are invented; the shape of a handover is not.